

Explain the roles and interactions of consumers, producers and decomposers within a habitat and how food chains represent feeding relationships

Learning intention

- explain the roles and interactions of consumers, producers and decomposers within a habitat and how food chains represent feeding relationships.

Teach and model

- researching the different types of decomposers and their importance within a habitat.
- describing how animals, including humans, obtain their food from plants and other animals.
- investigating the impact of introduced predators such as foxes on small mammal species in Australia.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.